



Claude Code Debugging Options

- I set up the hook, why isn't it firing?
- My MCP server won't connect — where do I check?
- API calls are slow, where's the bottleneck?

→ This is exactly what **debugging** options are for.

```
~/git/ claude --debug-file /tmp/claude.log
Claude Code v2.1.126
Opus 4.7 (1M context) · Claude Max
~/git
```

Debug mode enabled
Logging to: /tmp/claude.log

```
~/git/ claude --debug
Claude Code v2.1.126
Opus 4.7 (1M context) · Claude Max
~/git
```

Debug mode enabled
Logging to: /Users/seungjoonlee/.claude/debug/f00f40d6-4352-4ad5-b84f-442a8eac7104.txt



Why Debugging Options Matter

- Claude Code does a lot under the hood
 - API calls, MCP communication, Hooks execution, file I/O — all happening in parallel
- In **default mode**, all of this is **hidden** in a black box
- When something breaks, debug flags are essential to see "where it got stuck"
- If you're building Plugins, Hooks, or MCP servers, you'll use these almost daily



Why Debugging Options Matter

- **--verbose**

- When you want full turn-by-turn output
 - `claude --verbose -p --output-format stream-json "Why is the sky blue?"`

- **--debug [filter]**

- Trace internal behavior (API/Hooks/MCP) by category
 - `claude --debug "api,hooks,mcp"`
 - `claude --debug "!statsig,!file"`

- **--debug-file**

- `<path>` Save debug logs to a file (auto-enables --debug)
 - `claude --debug-file ./claude.log`